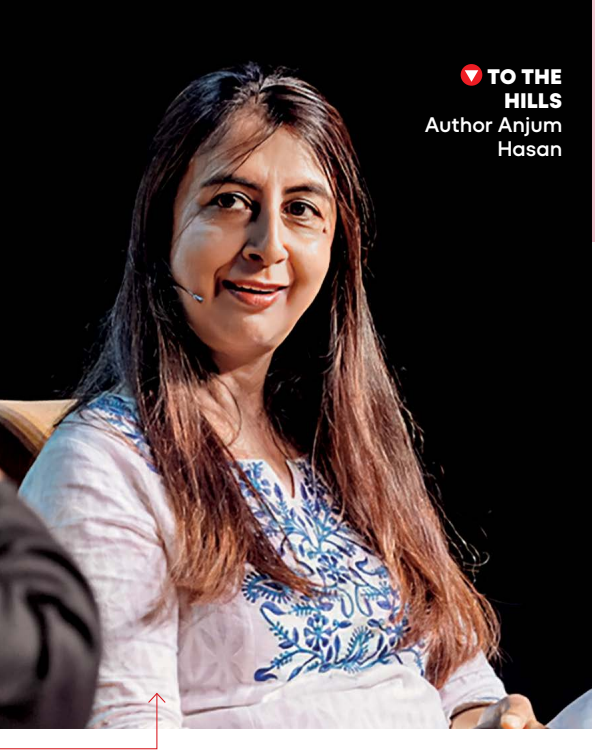
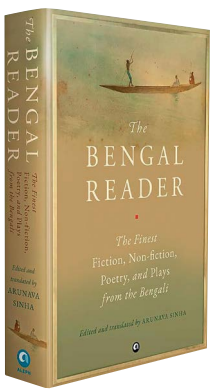


TO THE HILLS
Author Anjum Hasan

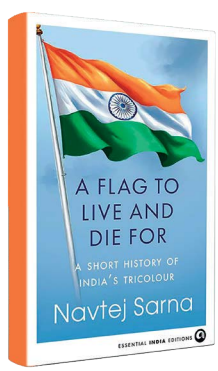
Edited and translated by Arunava Sinha
Aleph
Fiction and Non-fiction



A prolific translator of fiction, non-fiction and poetry, Arunava Sinha has brought together the finest Bengali works across genres in one volume, his 100th work of translation. The speeches of Rammohun Roy, the poetry of Rabindranath Tagore and the novels of Bankim Chattopadhyay; you will find them all in *The Bengal Reader*, the ideal volume for aficionados of Bengali culture and language.

A FLAG TO LIVE AND DIE FOR
A Short History of India's Tricolour
By Navtej Sarna
Aleph
Non-fiction

Draped across the arms of jubilant Olympians, covering the shrouds of martyred soldiers, or fluttering away in anonymous corners of the country, the Indian flag is central to the average citizen's ideas about nationhood and political identity. In *A Flag to Live and Die For*, the writer and former diplomat Navtej Sarna traces the extraordinary history of the tricolour.



THE BUCKET
By Arnab Ray
Hachette India
Fiction

Arnab Ray, the blogger and pop culture commentator known as 'Greatbong' online, returns with a cold case murder mystery set in Kolkata. In 1994, Pramila Chatterjee is drowned, followed by a hasty investigation wherein her neighbour is convicted and locked up. Thirty years later, a formerly inseparable group of friends are engulfed afresh in the Chatterjee case, as a true-crime documentary challenges everything they thought they knew.

THE DIG
Keeladi and the Politics of India's Past
By Sowmiya Ashok
Hachette India
Non-fiction

The 2016 Keeladi excavation has emerged as one of modern India's most hotly contested digs. Some cite it as incontrovertible proof of a thriving urban civilisation in Southern India while others dismiss it as political opportunism and mythmaking. Sowmiya Ashok traces the archaeological, political and socio-economic implications of the Keeladi dig, with some old-fashioned, on-ground journalism.



BY THE MUGHALS
Historian Ruby Lal

HUMAYUNAMA
By Ruby Lal
Juggernaut
Non-fiction

The historian Ruby Lal revives 'Humayunama', an unofficial history of the Mughal Empire written by Gulbadan Begum, considered a rare account of the times written from a woman's point of view. Gulbadan Begum was the half-sister of Humayun and the subject of Lal's previous book *Vagabond Princess: The Great Adventures of Gulbadan* (2024).

BREAKING THE BAR
The Early Women Lawyers of India
By Jhuma Sen
Pan Macmillan India
Non-fiction

In this series of profiles of pioneering female lawyers, advocate and law professor Jhuma Sen introduces us to fascinating characters like Regina Guha and Cornelia Sorabji, who fought both discriminatory laws (like the 1879 Legal Practitioners Act, which Guha challenged in court) and societal attitudes to pave the ground for future generations.

Compiled by Aditya Mani Jha